

1. Story Elements

Premise: A legendary retired assassin is forced back into the criminal underworld he left behind when a gangster's son kills his dog—the last gift from his deceased wife—and steals his car.

Backstory: John Wick was the most feared assassin in the underworld, known as "Baba Yaga" (the Boogeyman). He completed an "impossible task" for Viggo Tarasov to leave life and marry Helen. After Helen's death from illness, John receives a puppy named Daisy as her final gift to help him grieve.

Synopsis: Days after his wife's funeral, John encounters Iosef Tarasov (Viggo's son) at a gas station. That night, Iosef breaks into John's home, kills Daisy, and steals his 1969 Mustang. John emerges from retirement, seeking vengeance against Iosef. This puts him at odds with Viggo's entire criminal empire. John systematically eliminates obstacles, survives assassination attempts, and ultimately kills both Iosef and Viggo, avenging his dog and reclaiming his peace.

Theme: Grief and loss, consequences of violence, the impossibility of escaping one's past, respect and honor codes within criminal society, catharsis through vengeance.

Setting: Modern-day New York City's criminal underworld—The Continental Hotel (neutral ground for assassins), Red Circle nightclub, Russian mob operations, safehouse churches, and urban battlegrounds. A secret society of assassins operates with strict rules, gold coin currency, and specialized services.

Plot: Inciting incident (dog's death) → return to violence → declaration of war → escalating confrontations → infiltration of enemy strongholds → final confrontation → resolution and new beginning (adopting another dog).

Balancing Conflict: External (physical battles against waves of assassins, mob enforcers) vs. Internal (John's grief, his struggle between the man he was and the man he wanted to become, moral cost of revenge).

Shifting Focus: Begins with John's personal grief, shifts to his tactical execution of revenge, expands to reveal the entire assassin underworld infrastructure, then narrows back to personal catharsis.

Suspension of Disbelief: Accepts the existence of a vast, organized assassin society with its own economy, rules, and infrastructure operating invisibly within modern society. John's superhuman combat skills and damage resilience are accepted within the film's heightened reality.

Realism: Grounded tactical gunplay (gun-fu), realistic weapon reloads and malfunctions, practical martial arts (judo, jiu-jitsu), consequences shown through injuries, and believable criminal organization structures.

2. Characters

Hero/Protagonist: John Wick – Reluctant hero and grieving widower forced back into violence. Highly skilled, methodical, and driven by emotional pain rather than money or power. Undergoes transformation from broken mourner to purposeful warrior, ultimately finding closure.

Shadow/Antagonist (Exaggerated): Viggo Tarasov – Russian crime lord who understands John's capabilities and fears him. Exaggerated in his desperate attempts to stop John—sending armies, calling in markers, trying diplomacy. Represents the criminal world John tried to escape but can never truly leave.

Antagonist (Mistaken): Iosef Tarasov – Viggo's arrogant son who mistakenly believes he's untouchable. Doesn't understand who John is or what he's unleashed, dismissing his father's warnings until it's too late.

Mentor: Marcus – Veteran assassin and John's old friend who provides covert assistance. Represents the old guard's respect for John and the code of honor among professionals. His wisdom and sacrifice guide John's path.

Ally: Winston – Manager of The Continental Hotel who maintains neutrality but shows favoritism toward John. Provides sanctuary, information, and subtle support while upholding the rules of their world.

Guardian: Perkins – Female assassin who tests John's adherence to The Continental's rules by attacking him on neutral ground. She guards the threshold between order and chaos in their society.

Trickster: Avi – Viggo's brother and weapons supplier who plays both sides. His unpredictable loyalty and self-serving nature add uncertainty to encounters.

Herald: Aurelio – Chop shop owner who refuses Iosef's stolen car and warns Viggo. He announces to the underworld that John Wick is back, setting the entire story in motion.

Supporting Characters:

- **Charon** – Continental concierge; professional, loyal, provides essential services
- **Harry** – Assassin colleague who respects John enough to walk away from a contract
- **Ms. Perkins** – Rule-breaker who shows the consequences of violating the code
- **Francis** – Door guard at Red Circle who lets John pass out of fear and respect
- **The Doctor** – Patch-up specialist showing the infrastructure supporting assassins
- **Daisy (the puppy)** – Symbolic character representing John's last connection to his wife and humanity

Video Game Adaptation Potential: Perfect for a third-person action shooter with:

Perigren, Jomar A.

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- **Combat systems:** Gun-fu mechanics, close-quarters combat, tactical reloads, environment-based kills
- **Progression:** Reputation system, unlockable weapons/suits, skill trees (marksmanship, martial arts, tactics)
- **World-building:** Continental services (armory, medical, intel), gold coin economy, contract system
- **Mission structure:** Assassination contracts, territory control, stealth vs. loud approaches
- **Multiplayer:** Assassin vs. assassin modes, Continental rules enforcement
- **Narrative choices:** Honor code decisions, spare/kill options affecting reputation